

RL Final Project Grading Rubric

Total: 100 pts — Report 50% | Presentation 50%

Part I: Report (50 pts)

Category	Criteria	Pts
Problem Formulation	Clear definition; strong problem motivation and justification for using RL	8
Method	Well-justified algorithm choices; complete, reproducible technical detail	15
Experiments & Results	Sound experimental design (baselines, ablations); clear results; negative results acknowledged	15
Writing & Presentation	Coherent logic; clear figures/tables; concise language; consistent citation style	7
Novelty	Original contribution in at least one of: method, environment, or application	5

Part II: Presentation (50 pts)

Presentation time: 10 minutes.

Category	Criteria	Pts
Structure & Flow	Clear problem $\rightarrow$ method $\rightarrow$ results; good time management within 10 minutes	12
Technical Clarity	Core approach understandable to students outside the project; explains design trade-offs and limitations	18
Results & Demo	Intuitive results; can articulate what worked and what did not	12
Slides Quality	Clean layout; reasonable information density; figures over walls of text	8

Bonus: Presentation timing

Extra points for presenting in an earlier week, **on top of** the 100-point rubric above. Your presentation week is determined by the slot you sign up for (or are assigned).

Slot	Bonus
Week 1	+5
Week 2	+2
Week 3 and later	0

Notes

- **Negative results:** No penalty if the method underperforms but the analysis is solid.
- **Teams:** Equal scores by default; uneven contribution may be adjusted by ± 5 pts.
- **Academic integrity:** Credit borrowed code and prior methods; uncredited use is treated as plagiarism.